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POLICY NUMBER: FP-OPSFIN-124

Credit Card Data Handling

This policy includes guidelines for handling credit card data at Hotels.

POLICY STATEMENT

This Policy includes guidance around the handling of Personal Information, specifically credit card data. It is intended to promote customer and Team Member trust, to facilitate compliance with privacy and data protection laws, and to help manage privacy related risk, globally.

APPLICABILITY

All Owned & Operated Hotels (including Shared Service Centers supporting these hotels).

EXCLUSIONS/EXCEPTIONS

No exclusions.

CREDIT CARD DATA HANDLING GUIDANCE

Privacy and data protection laws and regulations expect Hotels to carefully handle credit card data in a secure way. This needs to be considered at all times and not only applies to guests staying at the Hotel but also applies to all third parties (e.g., travel agents, event organizers, tenants, etc.).

The Property Management System (PMS) allows credit card data to be securely stored in line with privacy and data protection laws and regulations. This not only applies to individual reservations but also to group and house accounts.

Credit Card Data Handling:

- 1) All credit card authorization forms containing full credit card details currently in use must be destroyed using approved shredding methods and cannot be used going forward.
- 2) Full credit card details must never be kept on paper anywhere at the Hotel. Full credit card details must never be kept in electronic documents on PCs or laptops of any Hotel Team Member.
- 3) The only secure place to store full credit card details is in designated fields within PMS which are designed to store full credit card details securely. These fields tokenize (or encrypt) the full credit card details and store the details in compliance with privacy and data protection laws and regulations.
- 4) Full credit card details must never be kept in the “comments” field in a guest reservation or in the details of a group account.
- 5) Full credit card details should not be emailed, faxed, or mailed. In the event the Hotel receives a document containing full credit card details, the Hotel must not accept nor use the credit card data and immediately destroy the document using approved shredding methods or by deleting the electronic file.
- 6) Virtual cards are one-time use credit cards that are restricted to the receiving hotel for a specific guest or group and may be accepted in the format received. When virtual credit card information is received, the Hotel must immediately complete the transaction in PMS according to the instructions provided, and then must immediately destroy the document received by using approved shredding methods or by deleting the electronic file.

DEFINITIONS

TERM/ACRONYM	DEFINITION
Finance Leader	Ranking Accounting / Finance representative for the property (i.e., DOF, Controller, or Finance Manager).